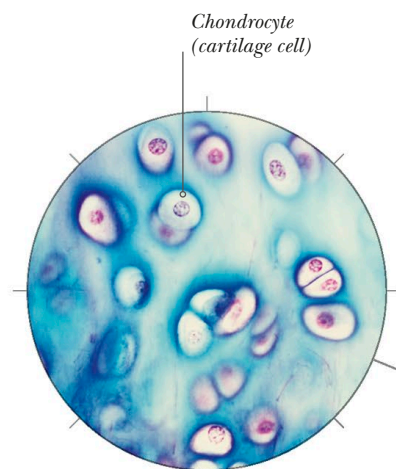




Chondrocyte
(cartilage cell)

Cartilage

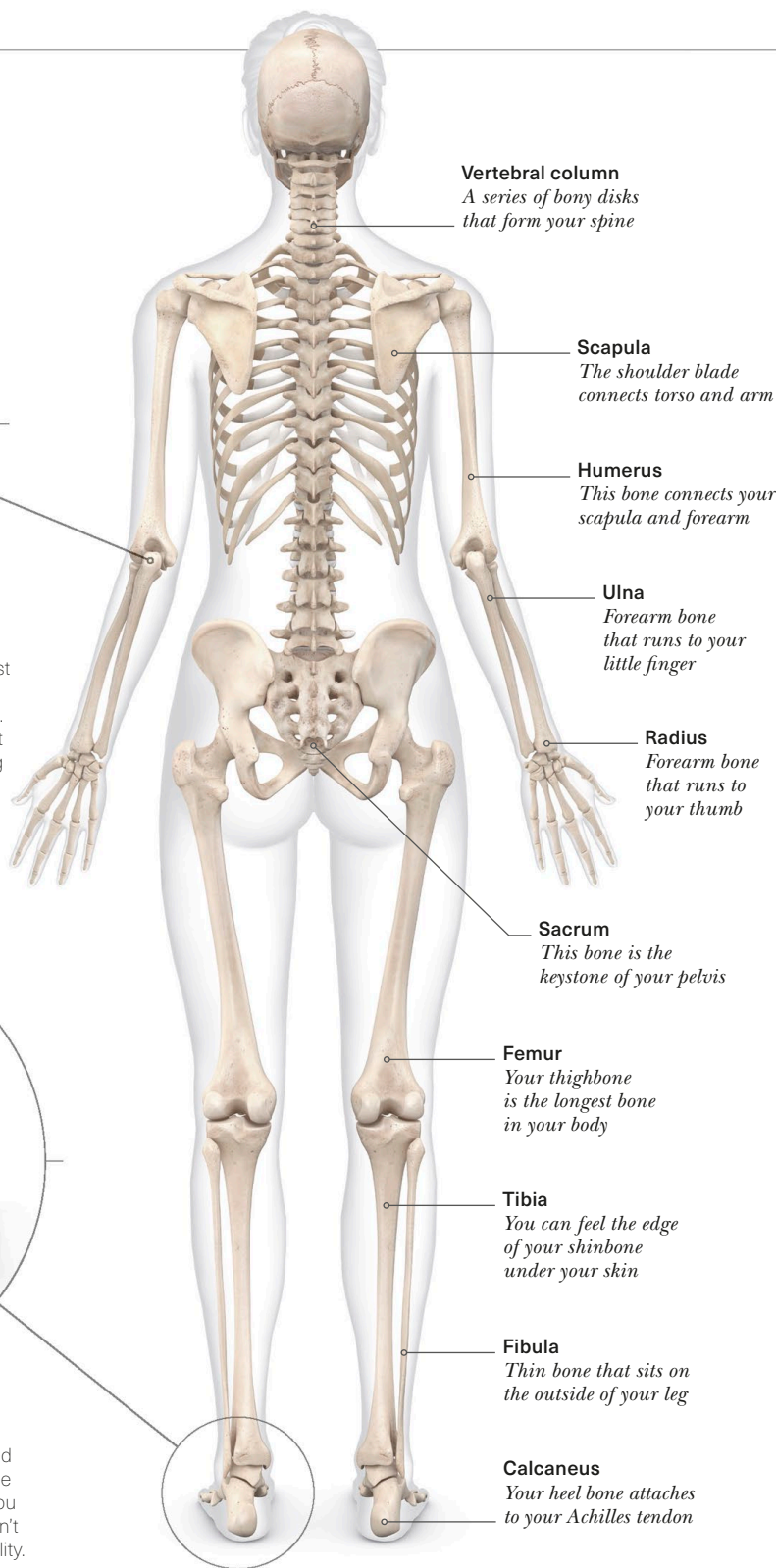
Hyaline articular cartilage lines bones at most joints and is smoother than glass—it even looks like stained glass under a microscope. However, when this cartilage wears down, it can become coarse like sandpaper, causing a condition called osteoarthritis (see p.17).



Ligament
attaches bone
to bone

Ligaments

Bones are connected by dense fibers called ligaments. Both ligaments and tendons (see p.19) have very little elasticity, meaning, if you overstretch them in an asana, they often don't go back to their resting length and lose stability.



Vertebral column
*A series of bony disks
that form your spine*

Scapula
*The shoulder blade
connects torso and arm*

Humerus
*This bone connects your
scapula and forearm*

Ulna
*Forearm bone
that runs to your
little finger*

Radius
*Forearm bone
that runs to
your thumb*

Sacrum
*This bone is the
keystone of your pelvis*

Femur
*Your thighbone
is the longest bone
in your body*

Tibia
*You can feel the edge
of your shinbone
under your skin*

Fibula
*Thin bone that sits on
the outside of your leg*

Calcaneus
*Your heel bone attaches
to your Achilles tendon*